

Machinehead -- Bush

Sixteen Stone, 1994. 147 BPM, est.

Dave Parsons' bass sits low, dark, and driving -- this is the grunge/alt-rock era, not a bright modern rock tone. GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

NAM: Ampeg V4B

Ampeg V4B -> Ampeg 8x10 cabinet -> Beyerdynamic M88 microphone. Slot 68.

This is the tone. A V4B pushed into its tube breakup is the classic mid-90s alt/grunge bass amp move -- raw, a little gritty, not hi-fi.

AMP and CAB are off -- the NAM replaces both.

- Gain: 58 -- enough to get real amp grit, not fizz. This is where the "dirty without being distorted" character comes from.
- VOL: 68
- Bass: 60 -- the low end that carries the riff.
- Middle: 58 -- pushed for grind and to cut through the guitars, not scooped.
- Treble: 42 -- kept dark on purpose. Bush's mix isn't a bright, clanky bass tone.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 28. A driven NAM at this gain level picks up noise between notes -- this keeps the low end tight without choking sustain on the riff.

PRE -- Micro Boost, on CTL.

Gain: 38 when engaged.

Off for the verse groove, on for the chorus. Same amp tone throughout, just louder and a bit more shoved into the front end for the hook.

DST -- off.

The V4B capture already carries the grit. Stacking a drive pedal on top would just mud out the riff instead of adding character.

AMP / CAB -- off. Replaced by the NAM.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +4, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: -4, 800Hz: -2, 4.5kHz: +5, VOL: 55.

Small low-end reinforcement, a cut around 400Hz-800Hz to keep the V4B from getting boxy under the guitars, and a push at 4.5kHz for pick/finger attack so the riff reads as a note, not just low-end mush.

MOD -- off. No modulation on this one -- chorus/vibe would soften a riff that's supposed to hit like a hammer.

DLY -- off. Straight, driving part. No delay.

RVB -- Room, on CTL.

Mix: 24, Decay: 38, Trail: true.

Off for the verse -- dry and tight, right on top of the beat.

On for the chorus, alongside the boost -- gives the hook a little more size without turning it into a wash.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: PRE (Micro Boost) and RVB (Room).

- **CTL off** -- main verse/groove sound. Dry, tight, driving. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- chorus sound. Boosted front end plus a touch of room reverb, same amp tone, bigger and pushier for the hook.

Engage CTL going into each chorus, back off for the verses. Simple two-state song patch -- no need for a third CTL'd module here.